6.5 Esophageal Varices

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • Vomiting a lot of fresh blood **Objective** • Known to have cirrhosis • BP 85/50 mmHg	**ACTUAL** **Deficient fluid volume** related to variceal hemorrhage as evidenced by hematemesis and hypotension.	Hemodynamics stable after treatment.	• Protect the airway; lie him on his side. • Give blood and the vasoactive drug (terlipressin, for example) as prescribed. • Get ready for endoscopic band ligation. • Give the prophylactic antibiotic as ordered.	Bleeding controlled: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Blood in the airway • Not fully conscious	**ACTUAL** **Ineffective airway clearance** related to blood in airway as evidenced by gurgling respirations.	Airway stays clear.	• Keep him on his side and suction as needed. • Give oxygen. • If ordered, prepare for intubation.	Airway clear: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Portal hypertension • Bled from varices recently	**RISK** **Risk for bleeding** as evidenced by risk factors: varices and impaired clotting.	No further bleeding.	• Once he has recovered, give the beta-blocker as prescribed. • Teach him that he must stop alcohol completely. • Book the repeat endoscopy for its scheduled date.	No rebleeding: **goal met**.